noting that the main issue is people seeking appropriate services to address their mental health or substance use/misuse challenge.

> *"We have an excellent behavioral health facility here. Excellent, it's probably the best I've ever seen."—Key Informant*

Key informants were concerned about the use/misuse of alcohol, methamphetamines, marijuana, cocaine, and opioids. There have been efforts to distribute naloxone kits to prevent opioid overdoses, although there is a potential need for inpatient substance use disorder (SUD) treatment in the community.

Key informants identified there have been increased mental health challenges in the past few years, particularly due to increased stress and isolation from the pandemic. Emergency Medical Services (EMS) is seeing more calls to 911 related to mental health needs. Health care providers are also experiencing mental health needs because of the stress and pressure put on them from the pandemic.

> *"COVID had made everything harder, but it did affect jobs and it did affect things like that. I think it has affected mental health issues, too. It has contributed to some more mental health issues or brought them out."—Key Informant*

They noted more concern about suicide and suicidal ideation, noting that suicide prevention needs to be a community effort, rather than only a clinical one. People helping people and connection is important for identifying people that may have suicidal ideation and getting them support.

To address community behavioral health needs, key informants would like to see more funding for behavioral health care and improved staffing. Key informants spoke to behavioral health care reimbursement models as inadequate, with not enough investment in the care. In general, people may look at behavioral health needs as personal problems, rather than a community one that requires community investment. Mental health care can also be prohibitively expensive for people, with some people not able to afford the care they need.

> *"Mental health is not valued across the board. There are people who really value mental health, but the rest of society does feel like it is probably a personal problem, and we don't have any obligation to help them. If they can't pay, no go."—Key Informant*

Maintaining behavioral health staff is difficult with turnover, along with a lot of the workforce experiencing exhaustion and burnout from the COVID-19 pandemic. Key informants spoke to the importance of creating a pipeline for developing the behavioral health workforce in jobs like social work. Subsidizing education and cost of living to help train people is one opportunity to invest in the workforce to meet the needs of the community.

> *"I think that it would be in our best interest to ramp up the college programming for the jobs that we need. … I also want to a see social work program set up. Then let's*